



**University of
East London**

**SCHOOL OF ARCHITECTURE, COMPUTING AND
ENGINEERING**

**Engineering
Postgraduate Courses**

EG7030

MSc Dissertation

**Module Leader
(Dissertation Coordinator)
Dr Ali Abbas**

RESEARCH ETHICS APPROVAL GUIDANCE

Overview

As students embark on their research dissertation projects, it is important that they consider any ethical implications of their work as part of this process. Please check with your supervisor to determine whether ethical approval is required for any research to be undertaken. This will be for **research involving human participants, or recruitment of human participants for proposed research (e.g. questionnaires, interviews etc), identifiable human material or identifiable data from individuals**.

If approval is required, then this must be sought by the student in the first four weeks of starting their dissertation work. This is mandatory, and students should be mindful that a breach of ethical approval occurs when a student submits assessed work later, such as a dissertation/research project that includes research requiring ethical approval, where such approval has not been sought, granted or confirmed prior to the commencement of the research activities.

Please remember that no research involving human participants, or recruitment of human participants for proposed research, may occur until ethical approval is confirmed. The ACE Research Ethics Committee will consider applications for approval of a research proposal in the following circumstances:

- Applicants are students on a taught programme based within the school (i.e. postgraduate taught programmes, where the research is a component of the course).
- The proposed research **involves human participants, identifiable human material or identifiable data from individuals**.
- Participants will participate in the programme on a voluntary and informed basis.
- Participants under the age of 18 will be able to give assent in conjunction with consent of parents or legally authorised representative.

ACE Ethics Committee Moodle site

Please see below the link to the ACE Ethics Committee Moodle Site for 2025/6, where students can access the updated application form and guidance alongside the monthly application submission links.

[Course: ACE Ethics and Integrity Sub-Committee 2025-26 | Moodle Home](#)

Research Ethics Misconduct

UEL Academic Misconduct regulations cite research ethics misconduct for the first time, so it is more important than ever that we instil good research practice and compliance. Research Ethics Misconduct is defined below:

A breach of ethical approval occurs when a student submits assessed work, such as a dissertation, research project, or other coursework, that includes research requiring ethical approval, where such approval has not been sought, granted or confirmed prior to the commencement of the research activities, or where the student makes a major deviation from any approved research without gaining additional ethical approval through the University's ethical approval processes.